

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

My Feeling · Show Me Your Face

Week 6

Week of Sep 21–24

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 6 · Week Overview

My Feeling · Show Me Your Face
Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Thursday →

happy

sad

angry

scared

calm

Littles (2.5–3)

One word + a face is a win: **"Happy!"** (huge smile, both hands to the cheeks), **"Sad!"** (one finger draws a tear down), **"Angry!"** (stamp once, then blow it out).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **"I feel happy today."**

"He is sad. I can help."

"I am angry — I need a big breath."

"I can ___!"

The week at a glance

MON	Happy Faces	a hand mirror in the Magic Box (an unbreakable one if you have it); a scarf over the box; the...
TUE	Sad, and Kind	one onion and a box of tissues in the Magic Box; a chopping board and a knife you keep well ab...
WED	Angry — Big Breath	a balloon (plus three spares) in the Magic Box; a two-pan balance with one black stone and one...
THU	Scared → Calm · Mid-Autumn · the whole song	the calm jar (water + glitter + a spoon of glue, lid glued shut), a mooncake cut into small pi...
FRI	No class — Mid-Autumn Festival	Nothing to grab. Happy Mid-Autumn

2 MIN
📦 **Magic Box hook**



4 MIN
📢 **Teach the words**



3 MIN
🎵 **Song · today's verse**



3 MIN
⚡ **Game · move it**



1 MIN
😬 **Whisper-shout close**

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **"One, two, three — eyes on me!"** · Kids: **"One, two — eyes on you!"**

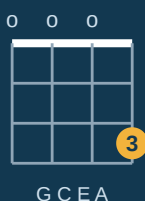
The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

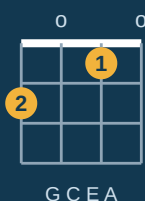
Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

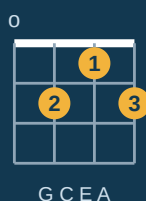
One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.



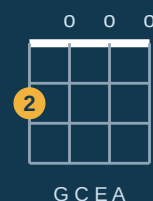
C



F



G7



Am

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up ("boom — boom — boom-chick"). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

The song needs only **C · F · G7 · Am**.

MONDAY

Happy Faces

Grab: a **hand mirror** in the Magic Box (an unbreakable one if you have it); a scarf over the box; the five feeling posters with **happy** on top.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box wears the scarf today. Shake it — one soft clunk. Hold it to your ear. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Lift the lid a crack, look in, and **gasp**. Shut it. Look in again. Gasp again.

TEACHER "There is somebody in this box... and they are looking straight at me!" (*pull the mirror out slowly, hold it to your own face, and grin enormously at it*) "Oh! It's ME. And I am **HAPPY!**"

Pass the mirror round the circle. Every child makes their happy face at it and the class says it with them. **"Happy!"**

4 MIN TEACH · HAPPY

Your face first, big and slow. They copy you before they say a word.

Happy! (*huge smile, both hands to the cheeks*)

My mouth goes wide, (*draw the smile with two fingers*)

My eyes go crinkle, (*squeeze both eyes shut, then open*)

Happy **inside!** (*both hands flat on your own chest*)

Say it three times — bigger each time. Then the mirror goes round again and each child checks their own happy face in it: make it, look, laugh.

LITTLES say the one word **"Happy!"** with hands to the cheeks — that is a full win at 2 and 3. **BIGS** say the frame: **"I feel happy today."**

Teacher fails: pull the biggest grin you own, hold it, and announce very seriously, "I am **so** sad today." Nod sadly with the grin still on. Wait. Let them fix you twice — the correction shout is the loudest English of the day.

Chinese character on the wall today: **happy**. Point at it as you say "happy" and they will start pointing at it for you.

3 MIN GAME · FEELINGS MIRROR

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Everyone kneels up facing you.

TEACHER "I am the face. You are my mirror." (*make one huge slow happy face*)

They copy it exactly and hold it while you count to three. **"Happy!"** Then a silly one, then a sleepy one, then happy again.

Now swap: one child makes a face, **you** and the whole class are their mirror. Every child gets a turn — ten seconds each.

BIGS name theirs first: **"I feel happy today."**

A child who won't make a face will still **watch** everyone copy someone else. Give them the mirror to hold instead — holding is a turn.

1 MIN CLOSE

Hands to the cheeks, whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Happy... happy... **HAPPY!**" (*the biggest smile in the building on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Colour Monster* (Anna Llenas) — don't read every word, just turn the pages and name the colour and the feeling together.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · HOW DO YOU FEEL TODAY?** chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C How do you feel, how do you **F** feel to **C** day? (*open both hands to the circle*)

Am Happy or sad — it's **F** okay **G7** either **C** way! (*thumb up · thumb down*)

C Show me your face and **F** show me your **C** hands, (*huge face, hands up high*)

Am Whale Class **F** listens — **G7** Whale Class under **C** stands! (*hand flat on your own chest*)

MONDAY · HAPPY FACES

C When I am happy my mouth goes wide, (*draw the smile with two fingers*)

G7 Sunshine, sunshine **C** right inside! (*hands on the chest, then out like rays*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. Sing it twice; by the second time the thumbs are already going up and down.

TUESDAY

Sad, and Kind

Today's word: **sad** (*happy comes back every day*)

Grab: one **onion** and a box of **tissues** in the Magic Box; a chopping board and a knife you keep well above small hands; a sad-looking puppet or soft toy; yesterday's mirror.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake it — nothing rattles at all. So **sniff** the box instead. Sniff again. Pull a face.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Hold the box out and let three children sniff it too. Then lift out the onion and hold it up like a jewel.

TEACHER "An onion. And *this...*" (*lift out the tissues*) "...is for what happens next."

Everyone leans in. "**Sad!**"

4 MIN TEACH · SAD

Cut the onion in half on the board, well away from the circle, and hold the cut side up. Let your eyes water honestly — they will spot it in about four seconds.

TEACHER "Look! Teacher is crying! And I am **not even sad** — onions do that to grown-ups too." (*take a tissue, dab your eyes, hand a tissue to the nearest child to hold for you*)

Now the real thing, slow and quiet:

Sad. (*shoulders down, mouth turns down*)

My mouth goes down, (*draw the frown with two fingers*)

A tear rolls down, (*one finger draws a tear down the cheek*)

Sad... sad... sad. (*both hands still in the lap*)

LITTLES say "**Sad!**" with the tear finger. **BIGS** say the two-part frame — the important one this week: "**He is sad. I can help.**"

Teacher fails: hunt everywhere for a tissue — in the box, under the mat, up your sleeve — while a tissue sits balanced on your head. Ask them, sadly, if anyone has seen a tissue. Wait.

Chinese character on the wall today: **sad**. Sad is **allowed** in this room — that is the whole lesson. Never rush a child out of it, just sit beside it.

3 MIN GAME · SAD TO GLAD

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The puppet sits in the middle of the circle with its head right down.

TEACHER "Oh no. Look. He is **sad**. What can we do?"

The puppet goes round the circle and every child does **one kind thing** for it: a pat, a hug, a blanket, a song, a whisper. Then they hand it on.

LITTLES do the kind thing and say "**Sad!**" **BIGS** say it as they do it: "**He is sad. I can help.**"

When it has been all the way round, hold the puppet up — its head comes slowly up too. Whole class: "**Happy!**"

Watch who is gentlest. Name it out loud by name at the end — that thirty seconds does more for the class than the whole rest of the game.

1 MIN CLOSE

Tear finger, then both hands out to the circle. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Happy... sad... I can HELP!" (*hands to the cheeks · finger down the cheek · both hands reach out*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Rabbit Listened* (Cori Doerfeld) — the whole book is "he is sad, I can help". Turn the pages slowly and let them say who is helping.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · HOW DO YOU FEEL TODAY? chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C How do you feel, how do you **F** feel to **C** day? (*open both hands to the circle*)

Am Happy or sad — it's **F** okay **G7** either **C** way! (*thumb up · thumb down*)

C Show me your face and **F** show me your **C** hands, (*huge face, hands up high*)

Am Whale Class **F** listens — **G7** Whale Class under **C** stands! (*hand flat on your own chest*)

TUESDAY · SAD, AND KIND

Am When I am sad a tear rolls down, (*one finger down the cheek*)

G7 Hug me, hug me — **C** turn round my frown! (*hug yourself, then turn the frown up with both thumbs*)

Sing this verse *quietly*, then the chorus loudly straight after. Sad, then okay — that shape is the point of the song.

WEDNESDAY

Angry — Big Breath

Today's word: **angry** (*happy · sad come back*)

Grab: a **balloon** (plus three spares) in the Magic Box; a two-pan **balance** with one black stone and one white stone for Autumn Equinox; a strip of tape on the floor for the balloon race.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake — a papery flutter. Peek, frown, and pull out one flat, floppy, uninflated balloon.

TEACHER "This is my tummy when I am **not** angry." (*hold the flat balloon on one fingertip, calm face, shoulders down*)

Then, slowly, one enormous breath into it.

TEACHER "And this... is my tummy when I **am**." (*the balloon swells, your face goes tight*)

4 MIN TEACH · ANGRY, AND THE BIG BREATH

Blow the balloon bigger in stages. The class grows with it, arms opening each time. Then the whole thing, on your own body:

Angry! (*stamp one foot, fists down by your sides*)

My face goes hot, (*both hands on your cheeks*)

My tummy goes tight, (*arms crossed tight, squeeze*)

Big breath **IN**... (*huge breath, arms rise all the way up*)

...and **let it go**. (*blow out slowly, arms float down, shoulders drop*)

Now let the balloon's air out *slowly*, squealing, right down to floppy again — that squeal is the sound they will remember the breath by. Three times together.

LITTLES stamp once and blow once: "**Angry!**" **BIGS** say the whole frame: "**I am angry — I need a big breath.**"

Teacher fails: take an enormous breath IN... and then shout even louder than before. Look pleased. Wait for them to tell you what you forgot to do with it.

Autumn Equinox is this week. Two spare minutes? Bring out the balance: the **black** stone is night, the **white** stone is day. Let a Big put one in each pan — the beam sits dead level. "Today, night and day are the **same**." The balance and its cards live on Tray 3 all week.

Chinese character on the wall today: **angry**, and **Autumn Equinox** beside the balance.

3 MIN GAME · VOLCANO BREATH, THEN THE BALLOON RACE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Everyone squats down tiny with their arms wrapped round their knees.

TEACHER "The angry is **down** here... it's coming **up**... up... UP..." (*rise with them, hands climbing over your head*)

EVERYONE "...and BLOW IT OUT!" (*one enormous slow breath out, arms flopping down, then flop to the floor*)

Three rounds — slower each time, not faster. Round three, hold the top for two whole seconds before the blow.

Then the **balloon race**: blow two balloons up, let them go, and everyone watches them squeal across the room and drop. Twice each side of the tape line.

Pop-shy child? Nothing pops today at all — the whole point this morning is that the air comes out **slowly**. Keep it that way.

1 MIN CLOSE

Stamp, then the breath. Whisper → normal → shout, and the **breath** is the loudest thing:

EVERYONE "Happy... sad... angry... BIG BREATH!" (*cheeks · tear finger · one stamp · one huge slow breath out — then everybody is quiet*)

Got 3 spare minutes? When *Sophie Gets Angry — Really, Really Angry* (Molly Bang) — don't read it, *show* it: point at Sophie's face on every page and ask "Angry? Or calm?"

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · HOW DO YOU FEEL TODAY?** chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C How do you feel, how do you **F** feel to **C** day? (*open both hands to the circle*)

Am Happy or sad — it's **F** okay **G7** either **C** way! (*thumb up · thumb down*)

C Show me your face and **F** show me your **C** hands, (*huge face, hands up high*)

Am Whale Class **F** listens — **G7** Whale Class under **C** stands! (*hand flat on your own chest*)

WEDNESDAY · ANGRY — BIG BREATH

C When I am angry I stamp and blow, (*one stamp, then blow out hard*)

G7 Big breath **IN** and **C** let it go! (*arms up on IN, float down on GO*)

Sing "let it go" slower than the rest of the line, every single time. That slowing-down is a breathing lesson hidden inside a song.

THURSDAY

Scared → Calm · Mid-Autumn · the whole song

Today's words: **scared** · **calm** — and **happy** · **sad** · **angry** all come back. (*Thursday is this short week's Friday: the whole song, the review, and the parent wrap-up all land today.*)

Grab: the **calm jar** (water + glitter + a spoon of glue, lid glued shut), a **mooncake** cut into small pieces, a **paper lantern** (one each if you can, one for the class if you can't), a small **red flag**, and every prop from the week back in the box.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out fat, rattling and glinting. Box chant, whispered.

TEACHER "Today the box is **FULL**. Who remembers?"

Lift each prop out in silence and hold it up — they will supply the word before you can.

Mirror → "**Happy!**" Onion → "**Sad!**" Balloon → "**Angry!**"

Then, last and slowest, the calm jar. Shake it hard and hold it up. Everybody watches the storm without a word.

4 MIN TEACH · SCARED, THEN CALM

Scared first, on your own face — eyes wide, shoulders up by your ears.

Scared! (*both hands up by the face, eyes wide, shoulders up*)

My heart goes fast, (*pat your chest quickly*)

I hold a hand, (*take the hand of the child next to you*)

Slow... slow... **breath**. (*one long breath together, shoulders dropping*)

Now I am **calm**. (*hands still in the lap, everything soft*)

Then set the shaken calm jar down in the middle and watch it — no talking — until every speck of glitter has settled. It takes about ninety seconds and it is the quietest the room will be all week.

LITTLES say "**Scared!**" with their hands up, and "**Calm.**" with their hands in their lap. **BIGS** say both: "**I was scared. Now I am calm.**"

Teacher fails: shake the jar hard and immediately announce, "There! All calm!" while the glitter is still a blizzard. Insist. Let them make you wait.

Chinese character today: **scared** and **calm**. The calm jar goes into the calm corner this afternoon and **stays there for the rest of the year**.

3 MIN GAME · FEELINGS QUICK-FIRE, THEN THE LANTERN WALK

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The five feeling cards face-down in your hand.

TEACHER "I show. You **be** it. Ready?" (*flip one card up*)

The whole class makes that face instantly and holds it. "**Angry!**" Faster and faster, then let a Big be the card-holder. **BIGS** owe you the sentence, Littles the word and the face.

Then **Mid-Autumn Festival**: lanterns up, walk slowly all the way round the room singing the chorus, and come back to the circle to share the mooncake sitting down.

TEACHER "May we all live long, and share this same moon a thousand miles apart." (*read it slowly, then say it in English*) "The moon is far away. The people we love are far away. And we can both look at the **same moon**."

Last of all, the little red flag: **National Day**. Not yet — we still have school next week; the holiday is **1–7 October**, and we come back on **Thursday 8 October**.

Mooncake is rich and the pieces should be tiny. Check your allergy list **before** circle, not during it.

1 MIN CLOSE · THE WHOLE WEEK IN ONE LINE

Everyone sitting, one action each. Whisper → normal → SHOUT — and then the very last word drops to nothing:

EVERYONE "Happy... sad... angry... scared... BIG BREATH — calm." (*cheeks · tear finger · stamp · hands up · one enormous breath out · hands into the lap, silence*)

The loudest word is the **breath**, and then the room goes quiet on "calm". That is the joke, and it works every single time. Send the wrap-up home today with the awards and the drawing sheets.

Got 3 spare minutes? *Thanking the Moon* (Grace Lin) — a whole Mid-Autumn family under one moon. Read it with the lanterns still lit.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · HOW DO YOU FEEL TODAY?** chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C How do you feel, how do you **F** feel to **C** day? (*open both hands to the circle*)

Am Happy or sad — it's **F** okay **G7** either **C** way! (*thumb up · thumb down*)

C Show me your face and **F** show me your **C** hands, (*huge face, hands up high*)

Am Whale Class **F** listens — **G7** Whale Class under **C** stands! (*hand flat on your own chest*)

THURSDAY · SCARED → CALM

C When I am scared I hold a hand, (*hold your neighbour's hand*)

G7 Slow, slow breath — **C** now I'm calm, I can. (*one long breath, hands into the lap*)

The finale: chorus → Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday → chorus, top to bottom, with the lanterns in their hands. They learned it one verse a morning without noticing, and this run-through is the review of the whole week.

FRIDAY

No class — Mid-Autumn Festival

There is no circle time today. This week is **four days**: Monday 21 to Thursday 24 September.

Nothing to grab. Happy Mid-Autumn — school is closed today for Mid-Autumn Festival and we are back on **Monday 28 September**.

WHY THE SHORT WEEK

Mid-Autumn Festival falls on the Friday, so the whole of this week's finale moved forward one day:

BEFORE YOU GO WHAT STAYS OUT OVER THE LONG WEEKEND

If your Friday does run (a make-up day, or a class that is in): sing the whole song once more, let every child choose the tray they liked best, and finish with the week's line — **“Happy... sad... angry... scared... BIG BREATH — calm.”** Nothing new; the week is already complete.

NEXT COMING BACK

We return on **Monday 28 September** with **Autumn (1)**. First circle back, before anything new: the mirror comes out of the Magic Box again and every child shows the class the face they wore over the long weekend.

★ How Do You Feel Today?

Week 6 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212) · Am (2000)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Thursday.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** How do you feel, how do you **F** feel to **C** day? *(open both hands to the circle)*
Am Happy or sad — it's **F** okay **G7** either **C** way! *(thumb up · thumb down)*
C Show me your face and **F** show me your **C** hands, *(huge face, hands up high)*
Am Whale Class **F** listens — **G7** Whale Class under **C** stands! *(hand flat on your own chest)*

MONDAY · HAPPY FACES

- C** When I am happy my mouth goes wide, *(draw the smile with two fingers)*
G7 Sunshine, sunshine **C** right inside! *(hands on the chest, then out like rays)*

TUESDAY · SAD, AND KIND

- Am** When I am sad a tear rolls down, *(one finger down the cheek)*
G7 Hug me, hug me — **C** turn round my frown! *(hug yourself, then turn the frown up with both thumbs)*

WEDNESDAY · ANGRY — BIG BREATH

- C** When I am angry I stamp and blow, *(one stamp, then blow out hard)*
G7 Big breath IN and **C** let it go! *(arms up on IN, float down on GO)*

THURSDAY · SCARED → CALM

- C** When I am scared I hold a hand, *(hold your neighbour's hand)*
G7 Slow, slow breath — **C** now I'm calm, I can. *(one long breath, hands into the lap)*

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“boom — boom — boom-chick”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4) → **Am** (4) → **G7** (4) → back to **C**. That is the entire song. C is one finger and Am is one finger, so two of the four shapes cost you nothing. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down and sing it unaccompanied with the actions — the class will not notice, and the actions are doing most of the teaching anyway.